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PORTFOLIO

QA Lead – Introduced the first QA function and gave the team confidence in every release

■ CHALLENGE

The client's company had no formal quality assurance and no QA role. Requirements and defects were not tracked in any consistent way, and nobody could say with confidence whether the software was ready before a release. Every release carried unknown risk, with no evidence to support or challenge the go decision.

■ MY SOLUTION

- Introduced the QA function to the organization and led and coordinated QA efforts myself, since there was no existing QA practice to build on.
- Put in place tracking for requirements and defects in Jira, with Zephyr for test management, so that what was expected, what was found, and what was fixed became visible to the team.
- Tested hands-on at every level that mattered before a release: the web and iOS user interfaces, APIs, databases, patches, logs, and third-party service integrations, plus performance testing.
- Added test automation for UI and API checks and integrated it into CI/CD with TeamCity, so release confidence no longer depended on manual effort alone.
- Result: releases moved from unverified to backed by tracked requirements, tracked defects, and test evidence.

■ TECH STACK

Jira, Zephyr, TeamCity, Nightwatch.js, Cypress, JavaScript, JMeter, Postman

QA Lead — Moved test automation to an up-to-date framework under test team ownership, growing it from 50 to 2,200 tests

■ CHALLENGE

The product's test automation framework was outdated and covered very little of the application. The automated tests had been written by software developers without a systematic approach, so the suite was hard to extend and coverage stayed low. Regression confidence depended on a small set of checks that nobody on the testing side owned.

■ MY SOLUTION

- Built a proof of concept to show that a modern framework would work for this product before committing the team to it, then introduced Cypress as the updated test automation framework.
- Set the structure around industry best practices: the page object pattern, fixtures, and reusable Cypress procedures, so new tests reuse existing building blocks instead of starting from scratch.
- Moved ownership of test automation to the testing team, so coverage was planned and grown systematically instead of ad hoc.
- Result: I made the framework much easier to analyze and expand and grew the number of automated tests from 50 to 2,200.

■ TECH STACK

Cypress, JavaScript

Test Team Lead – Unified QA practices across four Scrum teams and shifted test design from scripted cases to exploratory and model-based techniques

■ CHALLENGE

Testers in four Scrum teams of a large software product each worked in their own way, with no shared test process, techniques, or quality reporting, so quality could not be compared or steered across teams. Test design was also heavily scripted: testers followed prepared cases that confirmed documented behavior. As a result, edge-case bugs and defects in lightly documented areas of the product, where no script existed, escaped to production.

■ MY SOLUTION

- Led a group of 10 testers embedded across the four teams and owned the common way of working: a shared test process that I checked was followed or improved, instead of four separate approaches.
- Introduced test design techniques that do not depend on complete documentation: ACC modeling and pairwise testing to cover feature and parameter combinations systematically, and structured exploratory testing with deliberate attempts to break the software in under-documented areas.
- Used statistics and metrics to spot problems across teams and track their resolution, and ran root cause analysis (RCA) on escaped defects to find where the process or test design let them through, so changes were driven by evidence and not by opinion.
- Mentored and coached the testers on the new techniques and managed the group, so the practices spread through the people and did not stay as a document.
- Result: the four teams now shared one process, one set of techniques, and comparable quality data. The number of escaped defects dropped by 70-85%.

■ TECH STACK

MS TFS, MS Test and Lab Manager, MS Hyper-V, Excel pivot tables, MS SharePoint, MS Office